

JETPAKT · ONE-TIME SCAN

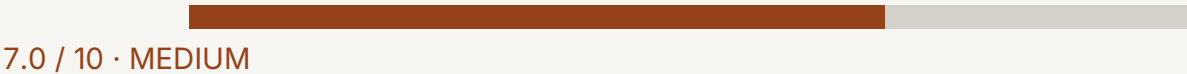
Sam's No. 3 — Downtown

1500 Curtis St · Denver, CO 80202 (CBD / Downtown)

Scan generated April 18, 2026

3.4	27%	3289	-0.90
Public rating	Recent negative share	Total public reviews	Rating vs. 3 local peers

Overall signal severity



Public review sources: [Yelp](#) · [TripAdvisor](#) · [Google](#) · [Reddit](#) · [BBB](#)

Prepared by JetPakt · ReviewSentinel methodology · Every finding below is tied to a verbatim public review.

Executive snapshot

Sam's No. 3 — Downtown is sitting at 3.4 stars across 3289 public reviews, with roughly 27% of recent reviews rated 1–2 stars. That puts the rating 0.90 stars below the 3-peer local benchmark (4.30 average).

The three signals driving the most guest friction right now are Service-Fee Transparency · Billing / Check Accuracy · Pricing & Perceived Value. All are actionable inside 30–90 days without capex, and none require public apology statements.

Legal-review recommended on: Service-Fee Transparency, Billing / Check Accuracy. See flag detail in the signals section.

Estimated recovery potential

\$8,300–\$27,310	\$99,654	2034–6689x
Estimated monthly recovery range	Annualized at the conservative floor	Projected ROI on the \$49 scan

Estimated from ~14,800 monthly covers at an average check of \$38 (price tier \$\$, casual category). We apply a 5% revenue lift per full star¹ and a 24% peak-hour uplift per half-star², assuming 0.1–0.2 stars of improvement inside 60–90 days after a single recommendation lands. Manager time saved on ~41 reviews/mo using defamation-safe drafts is added on top.³

Ranges, never point estimates. Recovery is conditional on executing at least one 30-day action from the plan below.

1. Luca, M. — Reviews, Reputation, and Revenue (HBS 12-016) — 5–9% revenue per star, independent restaurants; we use 5% lower bound (https://www.hbs.edu/ris/Publication%20Files/12-016_a7e4a5a2-03f9-490d-b093-8f951238dba2.pdf).

2. Anderson & Magruder (UC Berkeley) via ChowNow synthesis — 24% peak-hour uplift per half-star midpoint (<https://get.chownow.com/blog/impact-of-online-reviews-on-restaurants/>).

3. One-Haus 2025 Check Averages — QSR \$8–\$12 · casual \$28–\$52 · upscale \$55–\$95+ (<https://one-haus.com/blog/post/rising-check-averages-in-u-s-restaurants-causes-trends-and-strategies>).

Grow review volume — the compliant way

More recent reviews compound with the fixes in this scan: they improve Google local-pack ranking, smooth out the rating when a bad night happens, and give the 30/60/90 plan something to measure against. You have 3,289 lifetime reviews today — a realistic 60-day target is +12 to +25 new Google reviews at your current cover volume.

- QR card at bill drop. Print a neutral “How was it? Tell us on Google” QR on the check presenter. Given to every guest — never conditioned on a positive experience.
- Post-meal email or SMS (opt-in only). If you capture emails at reservation, send a single neutral follow-up within 24 hours linking directly to your Google Business Profile review form. Same wording for everyone; no pre-screening for satisfaction.
- Owner responses within 48 hours. Responding to reviews — positive and negative — is the single biggest signal Google associates with higher local ranking. Use the defamation-safe response templates later in this scan.

- Staff scripting, consistent across shifts. Train the FOH team on one sentence: “If you had a good time, we’d love a review on Google — no pressure either way.” No tip-linked asks. No competitions. No rewards.
- Google Business Profile hygiene. Keep hours, photos, menu link, and reservation link current. Post a weekly update. A complete profile gets asked for reviews more often by Google itself.

AVOID — these carry real penalties. Do not solicit reviews on Yelp — Yelp’s software actively filters solicited reviews to the “not recommended” section, where they don’t count toward your star rating¹. Do not offer discounts, free items, or contest entries in exchange for reviews — Google can remove reviews and suspend your Business Profile², and the FTC’s 2024 Final Rule allows civil penalties up to \$51,744 per violation³. Do not pre-screen (“review gating”) — asking only happy guests is an explicit policy violation.

1. Yelp Support — Don’t Ask for Reviews — Yelp’s solicitation policy and automated filter behavior (https://www.yelp-support.com/article/Don-t-Ask-for-Reviews?l=en_US).

2. Google Business Profile — Prohibited content — No selective solicitation, no incentivized reviews, no gating (<https://support.google.com/contributor/answer/7400114>).

3. FTC Final Rule on Consumer Reviews (effective Oct 21, 2024) — Bans fake, incentivized, and insider reviews; up to \$51,744 per violation (https://www.wilmerhale.com/-/media/files/shared_content/editorial/publications/wh_publications/client_alert_pdfs/20241009-ftc-finalizes-rule-banning-fake-reviews.pdf).

Top 3 quantified signals

Severity is scored 1–10 from recent negative share, review recency, and evidence density. Every signal is tied to verbatim public review text — the quotes below are the only claims this document makes.

1. Service-Fee Transparency

7.0 / 10 · MEDIUM

Category: Billing · Evidence count: 3 recent reviews

LEGAL-HIGH · Automatic gratuity / service-fee disclosure is a live regulatory topic in Denver (CCG lawsuit context). Any response touching on fee policy should route through ownership + legal review before publishing.

“Today I learned that my longstanding fave, Sam's No. 3 downtown, has added one of those pernicious junk fees. Now that the good guys have adopted these practices, are we doomed to see these fees persist in Denver?”

— Reddit, 2025-06-08 · 1-star ([source](#))

“Sam's No. 3 lacks sufficient transparency regarding the allocation of its mandatory service charge. Colorado HB25-1090 requires food and beverage businesses to clearly state the total price and provide information on how the mandatory service charge is divided among employees.”

— Reddit, 2025-06-09 · 1-star ([source](#))

2. Billing / Check Accuracy

6.4 / 10 · MEDIUM

Category: Billing · Evidence count: 2 recent reviews

LEGAL-MED · Price disputes benefit from menu-photo evidence and documented refund/comp policy. Do not argue pricing in public response threads.

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3. Pricing & Perceived Value

5.6 / 10 · MEDIUM

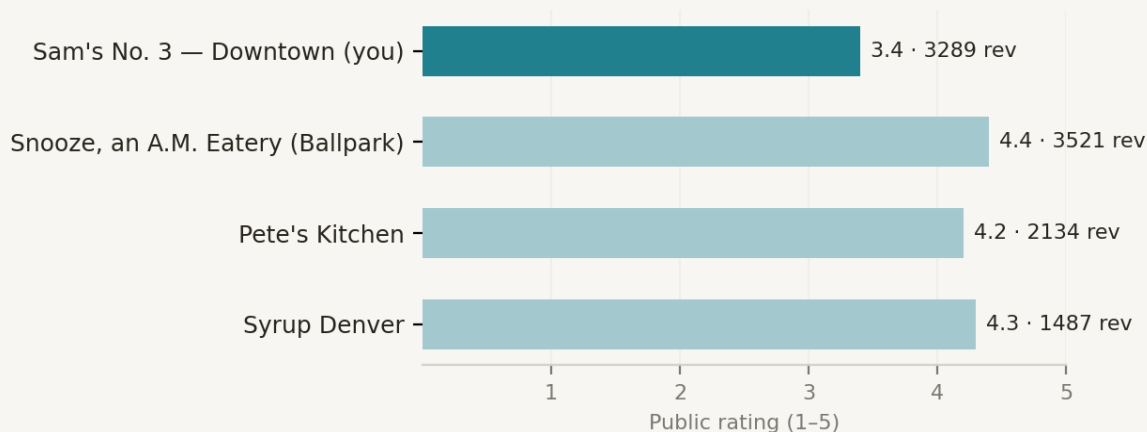
Category: Commercial · Evidence count: 1 recent reviews

“In recent years, they have increased their prices more than any other dining establishment I've encountered in Denver. A simple breakfast — 2 eggs, potatoes, and bacon — is \$15 now. That is pretty overpriced for what you get already. Another hidden fee on top of that overpriced breakfast is maddening.”

— Reddit, 2025-06-10 · 1-star ([source](#))

Local peer benchmark

Comparison against 3 nearby peer restaurants. Ratings are pulled from public review platforms (Yelp, TripAdvisor, Google). Peers are shown at reduced emphasis so your business is the focal point.



Location	Rating	Reviews	Tier
Sam's No. 3 — Downtown (you)	3.4	3289	\$\$
Snooze, an A.M. Eatery (Ballpark)	4.4	3521	\$\$
Pete's Kitchen	4.2	2134	\$
Syrup Denver	4.3	1487	\$\$

- Snooze, an A.M. Eatery (Ballpark) — [Yelp](#)
- Pete's Kitchen — [TripAdvisor](#)
- Syrup Denver — [Yelp](#)

Closing half of the current 0.90-star gap against these peers is the commercial target for the next 90 days.

30 / 60 / 90-day action plan

Concrete actions mapped to the top 3 signals. Owners are role-based so the plan survives staffing changes.

First 30 days — stabilize

Owner	Action	Signal
Ownership + Legal	Audit current auto-gratuity policy language on menus, website, and check footers. Confirm Denver disclosure compliance.	Service-Fee Transparency
GM	Train staff to verbally disclose auto-grat threshold at seating for parties near the cutoff.	Service-Fee Transparency
GM	Post all menu prices photographically in POS; enable item-level price alerts for modifiers.	Billing / Check Accuracy
GM	Audit top 10 menu items for price-to-portion perception; photo each plate against menu description.	Pricing & Perceived Value

30–60 days — systematize

Owner	Action	Signal
Ownership	Publish plain-English fee policy page on the website; link from Yelp/Google bio.	Service-Fee Transparency
GM	Monthly POS price-audit vs. printed menu; log variance.	Billing / Check Accuracy
Chef + GM	Introduce 2-3 visible-value items (lunch combo, happy-hour plate) to re-anchor price perception.	Pricing & Perceived Value

60–90 days — compound

Owner	Action	Signal
Ownership	Quarterly legal review of policy vs. current Denver CCG guidance.	Service-Fee Transparency
Ownership	Roll out digital menu QR with live pricing.	Billing / Check Accuracy

Owner	Action	Signal
Ownership	Full menu engineering review: contribution margin vs. guest-perceived value.	Pricing & Perceived Value

Defamation – safe response drafts

Five drafts tied to the most recent lower-rated public reviews. All drafts follow three rules: acknowledge without admitting fault, move the conversation off the public thread, and avoid naming any individual staff or guest. Every draft requires human approval before publishing.

Draft 1 · Reddit · 2025-06-10 · 1-star

“In recent years, they have increased their prices more than any other dining establishment I've encountered in Denver. A simple breakfast — 2 eggs, potatoes, and bacon — is \$15 now. That is pretty overpriced for what you get already. Another hidden fee on top of that overpriced breakfast is maddening.”

[Review source](#)

LEGAL-HIGH · Automatic gratuity / service-fee disclosure is a live regulatory topic in Denver (CCG lawsuit context). Any response touching on fee policy should route through ownership + legal review before publishing.

Suggested response:

Thank you for the feedback. We want our fee and auto-gratuity policy to be fully clear at the table, and your note is helping us re-review how we communicate it. If you'd like to discuss your specific visit, please contact us at downtown@samsno3.com.

Status: HOLD — requires human approval before publishing

Draft 2 · Reddit · 2025-06-09 · 1-star

“Sam's No. 3 lacks sufficient transparency regarding the allocation of its mandatory service charge. Colorado HB25-1090 requires food and beverage businesses to clearly state the total price and provide information on how the mandatory service charge is divided among employees.”

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Status: HOLD — requires human approval before publishing

Draft 3 · Reddit · 2025-06-08 · 1-star

“Today I learned that my longstanding fave, Sam's No. 3 downtown, has added one of those pernicious junk fees. Now that the good guys have adopted these practices, are we doomed to see these fees persist in Denver?”

[Review source](#)

LEGAL-HIGH · Automatic gratuity / service-fee disclosure is a live regulatory topic in Denver (CCG lawsuit context). Any response touching on fee policy should route through ownership + legal review before publishing.

Suggested response:

Thank you for the feedback. We want our fee and auto-gratuity policy to be fully clear at the table, and your note is helping us re-review how we communicate it. If you'd like to discuss your specific visit, please contact us at downtown@samsno3.com.

Status: HOLD — requires human approval before publishing

Draft 4 · Yelp · 2024-07-19 · 2-star

“The food was ok. The service was ok except we had to remind them about our drinks, refills, and they didn't hear us when we said we wanted a plain cheeseburger or a medium rare steak (came out well done).”

[Review source](#)

Suggested response:

Thank you for taking the time to share this — a wait like that is not the experience we want any guest to have. Our team is reviewing pacing during that daypart and we'd welcome the chance to make it right on a return visit. Please reach us at downtown@samsno3.com so we can follow up directly.

Status: HOLD — requires human approval before publishing

Draft 5 · Reddit · 2024-02-14 · 2-star

“Personally I feel the place is moldy and smells like skunky beer. Everything about the place is 30 years behind.”

[Review source](#)

Suggested response:

Thank you for the honest feedback — guest comfort in the dining room matters to us and we're reviewing our nightly cleaning checklist and facility plan. We'd appreciate the chance to host you again; please reach us at downtown@samsno3.com.

Status: HOLD — requires human approval before publishing

Where this can go next

This document is the \$49 One-Time Scan. JetPakt also runs continuous monitoring, multi-location dashboards, and workflow-integrated reputation operations.

Plan	Price	What's included
One-Time Scan	\$49	Snapshot + checklist (this document).
Monthly Essentials	\$99/mo	Ongoing sentiment monitoring across Yelp, Google, TripAdvisor.
Weekly Insights	\$199/mo	Deeper analysis, priority-ranked plans, trend alerts.
Multi-Location	from \$399/mo	Cross-site dashboards for groups and operators.
Enterprise Integration	Custom	API access, automation, governance, SSO.

Ready to move to Monthly Essentials or run this on another location? Reach Ryan B. at gojetpakt.us@outlook.com or 303-549-1697.

About the methodology

JetPakt ReviewSentinel pulls verbatim public review text, maps each excerpt to a controlled signal taxonomy, and scores severity from recent negative share × recency × evidence density. No individuals are named in generated body copy. Reviewer first names may appear inside verbatim quotes because they belong to the reviewer, not the business. Response drafts are generated from templates and always require human approval before publication. Legal-flagged signals (service fees, food safety, billing disputes) should be routed through ownership and legal review prior to any public response.